Qiyao Peng, ABD

Department of Communication
University of California, Santa Barbara
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Education

06/2027 (Exp.) **Ph.D. in Communication (STEM)**
University of California, Santa Barbara, Department of Communication
Areas of focus: health communication, persuasion, computational and experimental methods
Dissertation: *Multimodal Emotional Appeals in Anti-Vaping Videos on Social Media: A Computational Approach to Fear–Hope Flow and Message Effectiveness*
Committee: Jiaying Liu (Chair), Robin Nabi, Yingdan Lu (Northwestern University)

12/2019 **M.A. in Communication Management**
University of Southern California, Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism
Areas of focus: marketing, management, and computer-mediated communication

06/2017 **B.A. Honors in International Communications Studies with German**
The University of Nottingham Ningbo China
Areas of focus: cultural studies, film and media studies, media industry

06/2016 **Exchange: B.A. Honors in Culture, Film and Media**
The University of Nottingham (09/2015–06/2016)

Research Areas

Persuasion and message effectiveness · Strategic communication and health campaigns · Generative AI in persuasive messaging · Audience segmentation and message tailoring · Computational and experimental methods · Misinformation, information credibility, and AI-generated media · Human–computer interaction · Data curation and open science · Neurophysiological and psychophysiological measurement (fMRI, eye-tracking)

Publications

No books, monographs, or book chapters to date; all peer-reviewed work is listed by category below.

Refereed Journal Articles

[1] Liu, X., Lu, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Qian, S., Peng, Y., & Shen, C. (2026). Seeing the surreal: Mapping surrealism in photorealistic AI-generated images using large language models. *Computational Communication Research, 8*(2), 1–48. https://doi.org/10.5117/CCR2026.2.6.LIU

[2] Hong, J., **Peng, Q.**, & Williams, D. (2020). Are you ready for artificial Mozart and Skrillex?: An experiment testing expectancy violation theory and AI music. *New Media & Society, 23*(7), 1920–1935. https://doi.org/10.1177/1461444820925798

Refereed Conference Proceedings

[1] **Peng, Q.**, Lu, Y., Peng, Y., Qian, S., Liu, X., & Shen, C. (2025). Crafting synthetic realities: Examining visual realism and misinformation potential of photorealistic AI-generated images. In *Proceedings of Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human*

Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25) (pp. 1–12). ACM. https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3719834

Registered Report Accepted in Principle

[1] Rathje, S., Asimovic, N., . . . , **Peng, Q.**, . . . , & Van Bavel, J. J. Testing the causal impact of social media reduction around the globe. ***Nature***. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ujtxa_v2

Preprints

[1] Liu, J.*, **Peng, Q.***, Malik, M., Wang, Y., Norton, E., Ye, T., Markey, C., Worsdale, A., & Sweet, L. H. (2026). Identifying message "recipes" for high perceived effectiveness: Cognitive, social, and emotional profiles of vaping public education messages among young adults who vape. *medRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.10.04.26364669 *(Targeted for American Journal of Preventive Medicine)*
*Shared first authorship

[2] Zhao, S., Yu, H., Koban, L., Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Ye, T., Amlung, M., MacKillop, J., Sweet, L., & Liu, J. (2026). A brain signature of vaping cue-elicited craving. *bioRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.10.15.759290 *(Targeted for PNAS)*

Manuscripts Under Review

[1] **Peng, Q.** How peer discussion of cervical cancer screening centers on the exam: Topic modeling and network analysis study. *(Under review at JMIR Infodemiology; preprint available on SocArXiv, https://osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/e49jy)*

[2] Gonzales, A. L., Wang, L. H., Kim, Y. W., **Peng, Q.**, & Kim, Y. J. Meso-level theorizing of the digital divide: A model of organizational capacity for digital equity. *(Revised manuscript under review at Communication Research)*

[3] Worsdale, A., . . . , **Peng, Q.**, . . . , & Liu, J. Depressive symptoms alter the predictive value of neural responses to vaping prevention messages in young adults who vape. *(Revise & resubmit at Nicotine & Tobacco Research)*

[4] **Peng, Q.**, Duong, H., Shi, R., & Liu, J. Contradiction disrupts and reinforcement plateaus: The interplay of news and user comments on norm perceptions in the digital age. *(Under review at Computers in Human Behavior)*

[5] Ismail, I.*, **Peng, Q.***, Liu, J., & Oh, V. Y. Specific mixed emotional headlines drive online media engagement over and above positivity and negativity. *(Submitted to Cognition and Emotion)*
*Shared first authorship

[6] Gonzales, A. L., Kim, Y. W., Wang, L. H., & **Peng, Q.** The future of digital equity. *(Submitted to New Media & Society)*

Datasets

[1] **Peng, Q.**, Lu, Y., Peng, Y., Qian, S., Liu, X., & Shen, C. (2025). *AI-generated image dataset* [Data set]. Harvard Dataverse, V1. https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/MGJPBL
Publicly archived, curated corpus of photorealistic AI-generated images with human-annotated realism and content labels; supports *Crafting Synthetic Realities* (CHI EA '25)

Manuscripts in Preparation

[1] Ye, T., . . . , **Peng, Q.**, . . . , & Liu, J. Occipitoparietal response to vape packaging with food-cues indexes visuospatial salience and predicts future vaping frequency in young adults. *(Manuscript ready; targeted for Addictive Behaviors)*

[2] **Peng, Q.**, Nabi, R., & Liu, J. What do we measure when we measure emotion? A four-level framework for communication research. *(Manuscript ready; targeted for Annals of the International Communication Association)*

[3] **Peng, Q.**, Zhou, Y., Ye, J., Qin, T., Kong, K., Yu, H., MacKillop, J., Sweet, L. H., & Liu, J. Talking like a counselor: Conversational style shapes young adult vapers' acceptance of an LLM cessation chatbot. *(Manuscript in preparation; abstract submitted to SRNT 2027)*

[4] Liu, J., **Peng, Q.**, Zhou, Y., Ye, J., Qin, T., Yu, H., MacKillop, J., & Sweet, L. H. Beyond the black box: A randomized experiment disentangling module-specific effects of an LLM chatbot for vaping cessation among young adults. *(Manuscript in preparation; abstract submitted to SRNT 2027)*

[5] **Peng, Q.**, & Liu, J. Generative AI for scalable message tailoring: Differential persuasive effects across socioeconomic and value-based subgroups. *(Manuscript in preparation)*

[6] **Peng, Q.**, . . . , & Liu, J. Looking without thinking, feeling without looking: Discrete emotions drive visual attention and persuasion resistance through independent pathways in anti-smoking messages. *(Manuscript in preparation; targeted for Media Psychology)*

[7] **Peng, Q.**, & Lu, Y. When modalities disagree: A computational framework for measuring cross-modal emotion divergence. *(Manuscript in preparation; targeted for Communication Methods and Measures)*

[8] **Peng, Q.**, & Nabi, R. Empowering young adults against early-onset cancer: Balancing fear, hope, and psychological reactance in health messaging. *(Data collection in progress)*

[9] Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Ye, T., Sweet, L. H., & Liu, J. When stigma shapes resistance: Internalized stigma and responses to vaping prevention PSAs among young adults who vape. *(Manuscript in preparation; abstract submitted to SRNT 2027)*

[10] Douglas, B., Wang, Y., Gupta, A., Mallory, V., Pei, D., Adenji, F., **Peng, Q.**, Caruso, E., Juris, A., Ashley, D. L., Liu, J., Spears, C. A., Kostygina, A., & Popova, L. "For every rule, there's a workaround": Perceptions of and anticipated responses to policies regulating sales of flavored combusted tobacco products. *(Manuscript in preparation; abstract submitted to SRNT 2027)*

[11] Douglas, B., Liu, J., Reynolds, R. M., Pei, D., Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Gupta, A., Adenji, F., Juris, A., Caruso, E., Kostygina, A., Ashley, D. L., Spears, C. A., Kirpich, A., & Popova, L. DoubleTake: Study protocol of a discrete choice experiment with eye-tracking and an integrated randomized control trial among adults who smoke menthol cigarettes. *(Manuscript in preparation; targeted for JMIR Research Protocols)*

Media Coverage

04/2026 Cha, A. E. (2026, April 9). Social media addiction? This detox could reverse a decade of damage. *The Washington Post*. [Link]
Coverage of Rathje et al., ***Nature*** registered report

Honors, Awards & Scholarships

11/2026 Top Student Paper Award, Communication and the Future Division, NCA 112th Annual Convention
Paper: *Rethinking Emotion in Communication Research: A Four-Level Framework and Computational Measurement Guide* (solo-authored)

11/2026 Top Student Paper Award, Communication and Social Cognition Division, NCA 112th Annual Convention
Paper: *Pride-Anger and Beyond: Mixed Emotion Specificity in Online Media Engagement* (co-first author)

03/2026	Top Poster Award (Adolescent Network and Treatment Network), Annual Meeting of SRNT Poster: *A Theory-Informed AI Chatbot to Reduce Vaping Among Young Adult Vapers via Cognitive Control Enhancement: Insights from a Pilot Study*
2026 Fall	Dissertation Fellowship, Department of Communication, UCSB One-quarter fellowship with full release from teaching duties to support dissertation completion
08/2026	Student Research Award, Mass Communication and Society Division, AEJMC ($2,500) Project: *Generative AI for Scalable Health Message Tailoring: Differential Persuasive Effects across Socioeconomic and Value-Based Subgroups*
06/2026	Social Impact Award, Department of Communication, UCSB ($2,000)
2017	Zhejiang Provincial Outstanding Graduates, Ministry of Education
2016	Zhejiang Provincial Scholarship, Ministry of Education (RMB 12,000)
2014–2016	Best Student of the Year, University of Nottingham (Top 1, two consecutive years; RMB 30,000)
2014–2016	President's Scholarship, University of Nottingham (two consecutive years; RMB 30,000)
2013–2014	Dean's Scholarship, University of Nottingham (Top 10%; RMB 6,000)

Funding

Internal Funding

2026	Center for AI and Society Grant, UCSB Role: Graduate Research Assistant (PI: Prof. Jiaying Liu)	$8,000
08/2025	Social Science Research Grant Program (SSRGP), UCSB ISBER Role: Graduate Research Assistant (PI: Prof. Jiaying Liu)	$7,600
08/2025	Individualized Professional Skills (IPS) Grant Program, UCSB Graduate Division	$1,200
02/2025	Graduate Research Funding, Department of Communication, UCSB	$500
06/2019	CKIDS DataFest Research Funding, USC Viterbi School of Engineering	$3,600

External Funding

08/2026	TRDRP Predoctoral Fellowship Award, Tobacco-Related Disease Research Program, University of California Office of the President Role: Principal Investigator *(Letter of intent accepted; full application in preparation)*	
2025	TRDRP Predoctoral Fellowship Award, Tobacco-Related Disease Research Program, University of California Office of the President Project: *Emotion-Driven Persuasion in Anti-Vaping Campaigns: A Computational and Experimental Approach* Role: Principal Investigator *(Shortlisted; full application submitted; not funded)*	$181,539 (proposed)

Travel Awards & Grants

2026	Michael Haley Travel Grant, International Communication Association (ICA)	$900
04/2026	Doctoral Student Travel Grant, Academic Senate, UCSB	$1,500
2026	Health Communication Division Travel Award, ICA 76th Annual Conference	$200

2024 Game Studies Division Travel Grant, ICA 74th Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia $500

2024–2026 Travel Grant, Graduate Student Association (GSA), UCSB Graduate Division (three consecutive years)

2024–2026 Travel Funding, Department of Communication, UCSB (three consecutive years)

Invited Talks & Guest Lectures

09/2026 **Peng, Q.** Computational methods in communication research. *COMM 88 Communication Research Methods, University of California, Santa Barbara.*

06/2026 **Peng, Q.** "Don't make it about me": When AI-tailored health messages help, hurt, and why it depends on who you are. *Affect, Ambivalence, and Adjustment Lab, Department of Psychology, School of Humanities and Behavioural Sciences, Singapore University of Social Sciences.*

04/2026 Liu, J., & **Peng, Q.** Understanding health message effectiveness: Message profiles, neural responses, and behavior change. *Health Communication Symposium, Department of Communication, UCSB.*

03/2026 Liu, J., & **Peng, Q.** Personalizing vaping prevention messages among young people with generative AI: What we learned. *Tobacco Prevention Summit, Santa Barbara County.*

01/2026 **Peng, Q.** Internet, technology & health. *COMM 155 Health Communication, University of California, Santa Barbara.*

04/2025 **Peng, Q.** Digital media in times of well-being. *A Symposium on Digital Media & Well-Being, Department of Communication, UCSB.*

Conference Presentations

[C.21] Ismail, I.*, **Peng, Q.***†, Liu, J., & Oh, V. Y. (2026, Nov). Pride-anger and beyond: Mixed emotion specificity in online media engagement. *NCA 112th Annual Convention (Communication and Social Cognition Division), New Orleans, USA.*
Top Student Paper Award
*Shared first authorship

[C.20] **Peng, Q.**†, & Liu, J. (2026, Nov). Generative AI for scalable message tailoring: Differential persuasive effects across socioeconomic and value-based subgroups. *NCA 112th Annual Convention, New Orleans, USA.*

[C.19] **Peng, Q.**† (2026, Nov). Rethinking emotion in communication research: A four-level framework and computational measurement guide. *NCA 112th Annual Convention (Communication and the Future Division), New Orleans, USA.*
Top Student Paper Award

[C.18] **Peng, Q.**†, & Liu, J. (2026, Oct). What do conversation-level language measures measure? Evidence from a randomized experiment with an LLM health chatbot. *Text as Data (TADA) 2026 (Poster), University of California, Berkeley, USA.*

[C.17] **Peng, Q.**†, Liu, M., & Liu, J. (2026, Jul). Generative AI for scalable anti-vaping message tailoring: Differential persuasive effects across socioeconomic and value-based subgroups. *Summer 2026 NIH Tobacco Regulatory Science (TRS) Meeting (Poster), Bethesda, MD, USA.*

[C.16] Liu, J.*, **Peng, Q.***, Malik, M., Wang, Y., Norton, E., Markey, C., Ye, T., & Sweet, L. H. (2026, Jul). Identifying optimal cognitive, social, and emotional profiles of anti-vaping messages for young adults who vape: Insights from interpretable machine learning analysis. *Summer 2026 NIH Tobacco Regulatory Science (TRS) Meeting (Oral Presentation), Bethesda, MD, USA.*

[C.15] Liu, J., Markey, C., Ye, T., McMains, J., Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Norton, E., & Sweet, L. H. (2026, Jul). Occipitoparietal response to vape packaging with food cues predicts subsequent vaping frequency in young adults: The role of impulsive sensation seeking. *Summer 2026 NIH Tobacco Regulatory Science (TRS) Meeting (Poster), Bethesda, MD, USA.*

[C.14] Liu, J.*, **Peng, Q.***†, Malik, M., Wang, Y., Norton, E., Markey, C., Ye, T., & Sweet, L. H. (2026, Jun). Identifying optimal cognitive, social, and emotional profiles of anti-vaping messages for young adult vapers: Insights from interpretable machine learning analysis. *76th ICA Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa.*

[C.13] Liu, X., Lu, Y., **Peng, Q.**†, Qian, S., Peng, Y., & Shen, C. (2026, Jun). Seeing the surreal: Mapping surrealism in photorealistic AI-generated images using large language models. *76th ICA Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa.*

[C.12] Ye, T., Norton, E., Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Sweet, L. H., & Liu, J. (2026, Jun). Social influence vs. self relevance: Neural correlates of the third-person effect in social appeal anti-vaping messages among young adult vapers. *76th ICA Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa.*

[C.11] **Peng, Q.**†, & Liu, J. (2026, May). Generative AI for scalable message tailoring: Differential persuasive effects across socioeconomic and value-based subgroups. *Comm Horizons, Davis, USA.*

[C.10] Liu, X., Lu, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Qian, S., Peng, Y., & Shen, C. (2026, May). Seeing the surreal: Mapping surrealism in photorealistic AI-generated images using large language models. *Comm Horizons, Davis, USA.*

[C.9] Liu, J.*, **Peng, Q.***†, Malik, M., Wang, Y., Norton, E., Markey, C., & Sweet, L. H. (2026, Mar). Identifying optimal cognitive, social, and emotional profiles of anti-vaping messages for young adult vapers: Insights from interpretable machine learning analysis. *Annual Meeting of SRNT, Baltimore, USA.*

[C.8] Liu, J., **Peng, Q.**, Wheeler, B., Li, T., & Sweet, L. H. (2026, Mar). A theory-informed AI chatbot to reduce vaping among young adult vapers via cognitive control enhancement: Insights from a pilot study. *Annual Meeting of SRNT (Poster), Baltimore, USA.*
Top Poster Award — Adolescent Network and Treatment Network

[C.7] Norton, E., Markey, C., Wang, Y., **Peng, Q.**, Sweet, L. H., & Liu, J. (2026, Feb). Neurocognitive predictors of vaping reduction: Insights from Public Service Announcement exposure and machine learning. *International Neuropsychological Society (INS), Philadelphia, USA.*

[C.6] **Peng, Q.**†, Duong, H., Shi, R., & Liu, J. (2024, Nov). Congruent and incongruent norms: The impact of news and user comments on norm perceptions in the digital age. *NCA (Health Communication Division), New Orleans, USA.*

[C.5] **Peng, Q.**†, Lu, Y., Peng, Y., Qian, S., Liu, X., & Shen, C. (2024, Sep). A first analysis of the misinformation potential of AI-generated images: A cross-platform investigation of their content, context, and impact. *Trust and Safety Conference (Poster), Stanford University, USA.*

[C.4] **Peng, Q.**†, Lu, Y., Peng, Y., Qian, S., Liu, X., & Shen, C. (2024, Jun). A first analysis of the misinformation potential of AI-generated images: A cross-platform investigation of their content, context, and impact. *74th ICA Annual Conference, Gold Coast, Australia.*

[C.3] **Peng, Q.**†, Liu, M., & Williams, D. (2020, Nov). The moderating effect of player types: Who doesn't quit? *NCA (Game Studies Division), virtual.*

[C.2] Liu, M., Lynn, M., & **Peng, Q.** (2020, Nov). Effectiveness of virtual reality interventions in reducing depressive symptoms: A meta-analysis. *NCA, virtual.*

[C.1] Hong, J., **Peng, Q.**, & Williams, D. (2019, Jun). Are you ready for artificial Mozart and Skrillex?: An experiment testing expectancy violation theory and AI music. *ICA (Communication and Technology Division), Washington, D.C., USA.*

†*Presenting author* · **Shared first authorship*

Research Experience

University of California, Santa Barbara Santa Barbara, CA

03/2024–Present **Communication, Health, and Emerging Media (CHARM) Lab**
Department of Communication
Advisor: Prof. Jiaying Liu
Research on experimental methods, neurophysiological tools (e.g., fMRI), and psychophysiological measures (e.g., eye-tracking)

Graduate Research Fellow on the following projects:

• **Project Leader on Eye-tracking & Discrete Choice Experiment**
Behavioral intervention to mitigate nicotine addiction in digital environments (R01CA289552; NIH NCI & FDA Center for Tobacco Products)
PI: Prof. Lucy Popova (Georgia State University); Co-I: Prof. Jiaying Liu (UCSB)
UCSB subaward total cost: $357,333

• **Lead Data Analyst on Computational & AI-Assisted Analysis of Message Effects**
Neuroimaging approaches to improve prediction of smoking initiation and nicotine use escalation among young adult electronic nicotine delivery systems users (K01DA049292; NIH/NIDA & FDA Center for Tobacco Products)
PI: Prof. Jiaying Liu (UCSB); Total: $1,305,218

• **Graduate Student Project Leader**
Scaling socioeconomic and value-based personalization in health messaging: A thin-AI approach to advancing communication equity (Health Communities Project, ISBER, UCSB)
PI: Prof. Jiaying Liu (UCSB); Total: $7,600

Computational Multi-Modal Communication (CMMC) Lab

03/2023–Present Principal Investigators: Prof. Cuihua Shen, Prof. Yilang Peng, Prof. Yingdan Lu
Led and participated in research projects using computational methods based on Python/R

Graduate Research Fellow on the following project:

• **Project Leader on misinformation potential of photorealistic AI-generated images**
Understanding How Visual Features of Misinformation Influence Credibility Perceptions (CNS-2150716; National Science Foundation)
PIs: Prof. Cuihua Shen, Prof. Yilang Peng, Prof. Yingdan Lu
Total: $500,000

Northwestern University Evanston, IL

10/2024–Present **Computational Media and Politics (COMAP) Lab**
School of Communication
Principal Investigator: Prof. Yingdan Lu

University of Southern California Los Angeles, CA

01/2019–06/2020 **Game Studies Research Group & CKIDS DataFest**
Annenberg School of Communication & Viterbi School of Engineering
Principal Investigator: Prof. Dmitri Williams

08/2018–03/2019 **China KOL / Wang Hong Project**
Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism
Principal Investigator: Prof. David Craig
Research Assistant: organized ethnographic data and produced Chinese–English translations of 10+ interview transcripts; conducted background and literature research

02/2018–12/2019 **Things China Working Group**
U.S.–China Institute
Organizers: Prof. G. Thomas Goodnight, Prof. Ben Lee, Dr. Clayton Dube, Dr. Yue Yang
Participated in weekly research meetings and discussions on U.S.–China communication research projects

Selected Workshops

08/2025 **Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS-Stanford)**
Stanford University; IPS funding ($1,200)

Teaching Experience

Average student evaluation: 4.5/5 across all courses taught

Independent Instructor of Record (UCSB)

2025 Summer A COMM 89 Communication Theories (~50 students)
Designed syllabus, lectures, in-class activities, and assessments

2024 Summer B & 2025 Spring COMM 139 Communication and Emotion (~50 students)
Designed syllabus, lectures, in-class activities, and assessments; delivered in-person lectures

Teaching Assistant (UCSB)

2026 Summer B COMM 117 Persuasion (Prof. Robin Nabi; ~90 students)

2026 Spring COMM 187 Data Science (Prof. Prateekshit Pandey; ~90 students)

2026 Winter COMM 155 Health Communication (Prof. Jiaying Liu; ~90 students)

2025 Fall COMM 88 Communication Research Methods (Prof. Amy Gonzales; ~90 students)

2025 Summer A INT 93LS Research in STEM: Decoding Bias (Prof. Musa Malik; ~30 students)

2025 Winter COMM 148 Risk Communication (Prof. Katie Elder; ~90 students)

2024 Spring & Fall COMM 89 Communication Theories (Prof. Walid Afifi; ~90 students)

2024 Winter COMM 139 Communication and Emotion (Prof. Robin Nabi; ~90 students)

2023 Fall COMM 137 Global Communication (Prof. Michael Stohl; ~90 students)

Teaching Assistant (The University of Nottingham Ningbo China)

02/2017–05/2017 Industrial Marketing and Culture (Prof. Dirk Moosmeyer; ~50 students)

Mentoring Experience

Undergraduate RAs Supervised and trained 10+ RAs in the CHARM Lab on data collection, coding, and analysis
Managed 3 RAs in the CMMC Lab on computational data collection and annotation
Calista Schmidt — recipient of the Steven H. Chaffee Undergraduate Award for Excellence in Research, UCSB Department of Communication (2025)

High School Vera Lew (paper submitted to ICA 2026)
Yitong Huang
Mabelle Liu (abstract submitted to NIH Tobacco Regulatory Science Conference)

Volunteer Teaching

09/2013–12/2013 Volunteer Teacher, Chinese Young Volunteers Association, Ningbo, China
Supported weekly instruction for children with hearing impairment and autism

Work Experience

NorthKing Information Technology Co. LTD Beijing, China

09/2020–09/2023 **Brand & Marketing Manager**
Led integrated brand strategy and corporate communications for a Beijing-based financial-IT services firm serving major banks; designed B2B campaigns spanning earned, owned, and paid media
Directed market and user-experience (UX) research; translated audience insights into messaging, positioning, and public-relations strategy
Managed client and stakeholder relationships, social media presence, and event programming, including industry conferences and executive forums
Recognized as *Outstanding Employee of the Year* for measurable contributions to brand visibility

USC Games Los Angeles, CA

06/2018–06/2019 **Video Editor**
Produced and edited video content supporting USC Games programming and showcases

SEGA Stories International Los Angeles, CA

05/2018–08/2018 **Branded Entertainment Intern**
Conducted brand and audience research to inform strategic communication and creative-development decisions
Supported cross-stakeholder coordination and industry events that extended SEGA's storytelling presence
Reviewed and provided coverage on creative submissions for brand and audience fit

Los Angeles Chinese Film Festival Los Angeles, CA

04/2018–11/2018 **Marketing & PR Specialist**
Designed and executed integrated marketing and public-relations campaigns across social media, content production, and earned media
Produced editorial and interview content amplifying festival programming and partnerships

CCTV Weihai Movie & TV Base, Beijing Office Beijing, China

08/2016–09/2016 **Intern Program Producer**
Supported pre-production for the talent show *Heroes from Youngsters*

SINA Education Channel Beijing, China

06/2016–08/2016 **Intern Editor**
Managed social media marketing, live broadcast show planning, and online reporting
Received a 10% salary raise for outstanding performance

Academic Service

Reviewer

Journals	*BMC Public Health* *Health Communication* *Journal of Health Communication* *Journal of Applied Communication Research* *International Journal of Communication*
Conferences	*International Communication Association* (Health Communication Division, Computational Methods Division) *National Communication Association* *International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC^2S^2)* *Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS)*

Department Service

2025 Fall	Grad Buddy Mentor, Department of Communication, UCSB
09/2024	Panelist, COMM Jumpstart 2024, Department of Communication, UCSB

University Service

05/2026	Panelist, IPS Meet & Eat (Whole PhD 2026 Series), Professional Development, UCSB Graduate Division

Professional Affiliations

International Communication Association (ICA)

National Communication Association (NCA)

Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC)

Society for Research on Nicotine and Tobacco (SRNT)

NIH/FDA CTP-Funded Tobacco Regulatory Science (TRS) Research Community (Trainee)

Skills

Programming: Python, R, SPSS, Mplus, LaTeX

Software: Microsoft Office, Excel, Adobe Photoshop, Premiere Pro, InDesign

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (IELTS 8.5/C2), German (B2), Korean (TOPIK 3/B1)

Certificates:
Methods and Statistics in Social Sciences Specialization
Adobe Certified Associate in Visual Design (Photoshop)
Adobe Certified Associate in Digital Video (Premiere Pro)
Adobe Certified Associate in Print & Digital Media Publication (InDesign)

October 22, 2026